

Notes: Calderon, Fouka & Tabellini (RES, 2023)
Racial Diversity and Racial Policy Preferences: The Great Migration and Civil Rights

Contents

1	Big picture	2
2	Incremental contribution of this paper	2
3	Data and measurement	2
3.1	Treatment and sample	2
3.2	Outcomes	2
4	Models and empirical specifications	3
4.1	Stacked first-difference model	3
4.2	Shift-share instrument	3
4.3	Newspaper event-study model	3
5	Identification and empirical design	3
6	Tables and figures	3
6.1	Figure 1: Great Migration and Northern Whites' Attitudes; Figure 2: Change in Black Population Share, 1940–70	3
6.2	Figure 3: Discharge Petitions by Party; Table 1: Summary Statistics	4
6.3	Table 2: Congressional Elections	5
6.4	Table 3: Changes in Legislators' Ideology; Figure 4: Discharge-Petition Signatures	5
6.5	Table 4: NAACP Chapters and CORE Demonstrations	6
6.6	Figure 5: White Voters; Table 5: Whites' Attitudes from the ANES	6
6.7	Tables 6–7 and Figures 6–7: Newspapers, Event Studies, and Heterogeneity	7
7	Short summary	8
8	Conclusion	8
8.1	Core conclusion	8
8.2	Incremental contribution revisited	8
8.3	Mechanism	8
8.4	Limits and open questions	9
8.5	Takeaway	9

1 Big picture

- **Question.** Did the Second Great Migration help build political support for civil rights outside the US South?
- **Main result.** Black in-migration increased Democratic vote shares in non-southern Congressional elections and made legislators more likely to support civil-rights legislation.
- **Identification.** The paper uses a shift-share instrument that allocates southern outflows to northern counties according to 1940 settlement patterns of Black migrants by southern state of birth.
- **Mechanisms.** Migration strengthened Black organizations, transmitted information about southern racial violence, and enabled cross-race coalitions in places with labour and Democratic political capacity.
- **Takeaway.** Racial diversity can create backlash, but in this setting it increased support for racial equality because political power, information, and coalition incentives aligned.

2 Incremental contribution of this paper

- **From backlash to coalition formation.** The paper shows a historical case in which minority in-migration increased majority support for minority rights.
- **Links migration to national civil-rights politics.** It adds the political channel to the Great Migration literature by showing effects on voters, legislators, organizations, media, and survey attitudes.
- **Explains the northern role in civil rights.** It shows why northern districts mattered for policies whose direct constraints fell mainly on the South.
- **Mechanism contribution.** The paper distinguishes Black voter arithmetic from white voter switching, organizational mobilization, information diffusion, and labour-Democratic coalition formation.
- **Empirical contribution.** The shift-share design uses pre-existing southern-origin enclaves to predict later Black inflows and is paired with robustness checks using alternative push instruments and units of analysis.

3 Data and measurement

3.1 Treatment and sample

The core treatment is the decadal change in the Black population share in non-southern counties or Congressional districts. The main county sample contains 1,263 non-southern counties observed between 1940 and 1970.

Interpretation. The treatment is not simply racial diversity in levels; it is the demographic shock produced by the Second Great Migration.

3.2 Outcomes

The paper studies Democratic vote shares, turnout, legislators' civil-rights ideology scores, discharge-petition signatures, NAACP chapter presence, CORE demonstrations, ANES white attitudes, and newspaper mentions of southern lynchings.

Interpretation. The breadth of outcomes lets the paper trace migration through voters, representatives, organizations, media, and white opinion.

4 Models and empirical specifications

4.1 Stacked first-difference model

$$\Delta y_{c\tau} = \delta_{s\tau} + \beta \Delta Bl_{c\tau} + \gamma X_{c\tau} + u_{c\tau}.$$

Interpretation. The coefficient β compares changes in outcomes within non-southern counties or districts receiving different changes in Black population share.

4.2 Shift-share instrument

$$Z_{c\tau} = \sum_{j \in South} sh_{jc} Bl_{j\tau}.$$

Here sh_{jc} is the share of Black migrants born in southern state j who lived in northern county c in 1940, and $Bl_{j\tau}$ is the number leaving southern state j during decade τ .

Interpretation. The instrument predicts where migrants would go based on historical networks while using origin-state outflows as shocks.

4.3 Newspaper event-study model

$$Mention_{c,e,w} = \alpha_c + \alpha_e + \alpha_{s \times w} + \beta(\Delta Bl_c \times Post_w) + \varepsilon_{c,e,w}.$$

Interpretation. This tests whether high-inflow northern counties mention southern lynchings more after the events occur.

5 Identification and empirical design

The identifying assumption is that, conditional on controls, post-1940 support for civil rights in northern counties is not simultaneously correlated with the 1940 southern-origin composition of Black enclaves and subsequent southern out-migration shocks. The paper controls for state-by-decade effects, 1940 Black share trends, and 1940 Democratic-incumbency trends; tests alternative instruments; and repeats core estimates at the commuting-zone level.

6 Tables and figures

6.1 Figure 1: Great Migration and Northern Whites' Attitudes; Figure 2: Change in Black Population Share, 1940–70

Read: Figure 1 shows positive relationships between Black inflows and white attitudes toward civil rights, Black Americans, NAACP, and CORE. Figure 2 maps the broad geographic distribution of Black inflows.

Economic message. Raw patterns motivate the causal analysis: high-inflow places appear more supportive of civil rights.

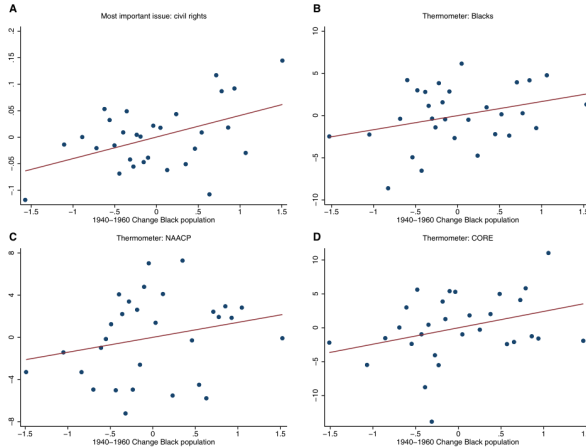


FIGURE 1
Great migration and Northern Whites' attitudes

Notes: Each panel plots the relationship between the 1940 and 1960 change in the Black population across non-southern US states a racial attitudes of white ANES respondents in 1964. The underlying OLS regressions partial out Census divisions dummies, the 1940–change in state population, individual characteristics of survey respondents, and 1940 state-level socio-economic controls. Individual controls include: age, gender, educational attainment, and marital status. State-level controls include: Black population share, Democratic vote share, and civil rights scores.

(a) Figure 1: Great Migration and Northern Whites' attitudes

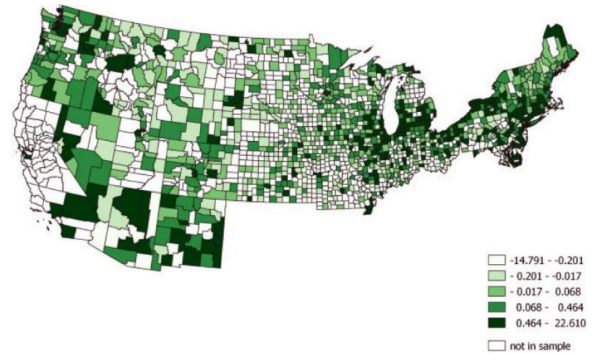


FIGURE 2

Change in Black population share, 1940–70

Notes: The map plots the 1940–70 change in the Black population share for the non-southern counties (1,263) in our sample. Source: Authors' calculations from Ruggles, Genadek, Goeken, Grover and Sobek (2020).

(b) Figure 2: Change in Black population share

6.2 Figure 3: Discharge Petitions by Party; Table 1: Summary Statistics

Read: Figure 3 shows that non-southern Democrats were much more likely than Republicans to sign civil-rights discharge petitions. Table 1 reports baseline levels and decadal changes.

Economic message. Democratic vote share is a meaningful proxy for civil-rights support outside the South.

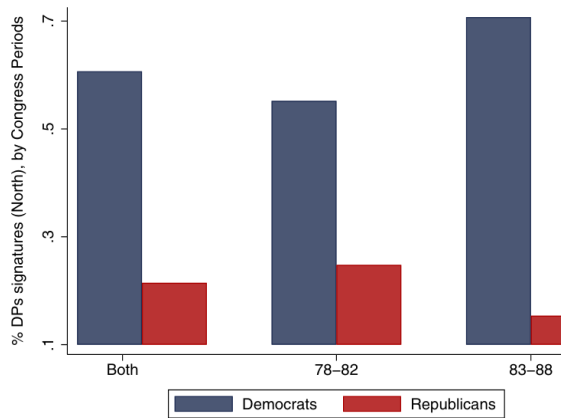


FIGURE 3

Discharge petitions on civil rights signed by non-southern legislators

Figure 3 (respectively red) bars plot the share of non-southern Democratic (respectively Republican) members of Congress who signed civil rights bills between Congress 78 (1943–45) and Congress 88 (1963–65). The age between the 78–82 and the 83–88 Congress periods, while the remaining bars display results for the 1943–45 and 1963–65 Congress periods separately. See [Supplementary Table A.3](#) for the mapping of Congress numbers to calendar years and [Schickler \(2009\)](#).

(a) Figure 3

TABLE 1
Summary statistics

Variables	Mean	St. Dev.	Median	Min	Max	C
Panel A: 1940 levels						
Black Share (County)	0.04	0.04	0.02	0	0.47	1
Black Share (CD)	0.07	0.05	0.07	0	0.25	1
Democratic vote share	46.55	12.91	49.00	0	85.00	1
Turnout	69.39	8.30	69.60	23.00	97.90	1
Civil rights scores	−0.09	0.71	−0.81	−2.01	1.43	1
Panel B: Changes						
Black Share (County)	1.78	2.53	0.72	−11.88	12.79	3
Black Share (CD)	5.25	2.81	5.58	−1.26	12.86	3
Democratic vote share	1.53	11.12	0.67	−67.19	72.80	3
Turnout	−6.49	17.06	−13.50	−64.30	43.00	3
Civil rights scores	0.07	0.71	0	−2.91	1.95	3

Notes: The sample includes the 1,263 non-southern US counties (see [Supplementary Table A.1](#) for the list of southern states) for which electoral returns in Congressional elections are available for all Census years between 1940 and 1970, with at least one African American resident in 1940. When relevant, county variables are collapsed at the Congressional District level, fixing boundaries to Congress 78 (1943–45) as explained in the text. Democratic vote share and turnout refer to Congressional elections, and civil rights scores are the agnostic ideology scores from [Bateman et al. \(2017\)](#). Panel A presents 1940 values (except for ideology scores, which refer to Congress 78, 1943–45), while Panel B reports decadal changes for each of the variables.

(b) Table 1

6.3 Table 2: Congressional Elections

Read: Preferred 2SLS estimates show that a one-percentage-point increase in Black population share raises Democratic vote share by 1.885 percentage points and raises turnout.

Economic message. Migration shifts the broader electoral equilibrium, not only the number of Black voters.

TABLE 2
Congressional elections

	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
	OLS	OLS	OLS	2SLS	2SLS	2SLS	2SLS	2SLS
Panel A: Change in democratic vote share (1940 mean: 46.55)								
Change black	0.537***	0.538***	0.611***	0.712***	1.255***	1.885***	1.938***	2.015
Share	(0.108)	(0.124)	(0.146)	(0.162)	(0.277)	(0.439)	(0.464)	(0.626)
Panel B: Change in turnout (1940 mean: 69.39)								
Change black	-0.274**	-0.298***	-0.293***	0.094	0.399*	0.756**	0.809**	0.665
Share	(0.121)	(0.112)	(0.109)	(0.187)	(0.235)	(0.348)	(0.356)	(0.459)
Panel C: First stage								
Predicted change				0.976***	1.002***	0.758***	0.803***	0.859
Black share				(0.261)	(0.260)	(0.233)	(0.249)	(0.283)
Specification	FD	FD	FD	FD	FD	FD	LD	FD
Unit	County	County	County	County	County	County	County	CZ
1940 black share		X	X		X	X	X	X
1940 Dem incumbent			X			X	X	X
F-stat				13.95	14.88	10.57	10.42	9.21
Observations	3,789	3,789	3,789	3,789	3,789	3,789	1,263	1,20

Notes: The sample includes the 1,263 non-southern US counties (see [Supplementary Table A.1](#) for the definition southern states) for which electoral returns in Congressional elections are available for all Census years between 1950 and 1970, and with at least one African American resident in 1940. The table reports stacked first difference regressions in Columns 1 to 6, and long difference regressions in Column 7. Column 8 replicates column 6 by aggregating the unit of analysis to the commuting zone (CZ). The dependent variable is the decadal change in the Democratic vote share (respectively turnout) in Congressional elections in Panel A (respectively Panel B). Panel C reports the first stage associated with 2SLS regressions. Columns 1–3 estimate equation (1) in the text with OLS, while remaining columns report 2SLS estimates. The main regressor of interest is the change in the Black population share, which is instrumented with the shift-share instrument described in equation (2) in the text from column 4 onwards. All regressions are weighted by 1940 county population, and include interactions between period dummies and state dummies. 1940 Black share

Table 2: Congressional elections

6.4 Table 3: Changes in Legislators' Ideology; Figure 4: Discharge-Petition Signatures

Read: Table 3 shows leftward movement in civil-rights ideology especially in the earlier Congress period. Figure 4 shows positive effects on civil-rights discharge-petition signatures.

Economic message. Migration changed representation and legislative behaviour.

TABLE 3
Changes in legislators' ideology

Dependent variable	Change in civil rights ideology (lower values = more liberal ideology)					
	Agnostic scores (Baseline mean: -0.873)			Constrained scores (Baseline mean: -0.854)		
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Panel A: OLS						
Change black share	0.008 (0.014)	-0.139*** (0.036)	0.049** (0.020)	0.002 (0.015)	-0.150*** (0.041)	0.044** (0.022)
Panel B: 2SLS						
Change black share	-0.051 (0.039)	-0.300*** (0.116)	0.046 (0.056)	-0.054 (0.041)	-0.337*** (0.124)	0.058 (0.059)
Panel C: First stage						
Predicted change	1.570*** (0.438)	1.054*** (0.377)	1.944*** (0.557)	1.553*** (0.442)	1.050*** (0.377)	1.917*** (0.564)
Black share	12.87	7.81	12.19	12.35	7.77	11.57
F-stat	570	285	285	570	285	285
Observations	78-82; 82-88	78-82	82-88	78-82; 82-88	78-82	82-88

Notes: The dependent variable is the change in the civil rights ideology scores from Bateman *et al.* (2017). Agnostic score in Columns 1-3, and Constrained scores in Columns 4-6. Lower values of the score refer to more liberal ideology (see also Bateman *et al.*, 2017, for more details). Columns 1 and 4 (respectively 2-3, and 5-6) estimate stacked first difference regressions (respectively first difference regressions for Congress period 78-82 and 82-88). See [Supplementary Table A](#) for the mapping of Congress numbers to calendar years. Panel A reports OLS results and Panel B reports 2SLS results while Panel C presents first stage estimates. The main regressor of interest is the change in the Black population share which is instrumented with the shift-share instrument described in equation (2) in the text. All regressions are weighted by 1940 congressional district population, and include interactions between period dummies and: (1) state dummies; (2) 1940 Black population share in the district; (3) a dummy equal to one for Democratic incumbency in the district in Congress 78; and (4) the ideology score in the district in Congress 78. First difference regressions do not include interactions with

(a) Table 3

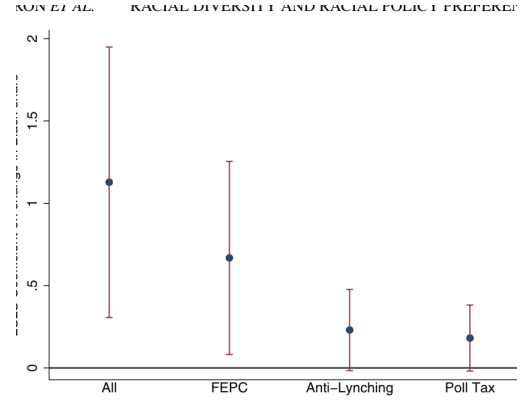


FIGURE 4
Change in signatures on discharge petitions
Figure 4 plots the 2SLS coefficient (with corresponding 95% confidence intervals) for the effects of the 1940-50 change in Black population share on the number of signatures on discharge petitions per legislator. The x-axis labels discharge petitions on employment protection legislation (FEPC), to promote anti-lynching legislation

(b) Figure 4

6.5 Table 4: NAACP Chapters and CORE Demonstrations

Read: Black inflows increased CORE demonstrations and increased NAACP presence among counties without an initial chapter.

Economic message. Migration expanded the organizational infrastructure of the civil-rights movement outside the South.

TABLE 4
NAACP chapters and CORE demonstrations

Dependent variable	Change in					
	I[NAACP Chapter]			I[CORE Demonstrations]		
	(1) OLS	(2) 2SLS	(3) 2SLS	(4) OLS	(5) 2SLS	(6) 2SLS
Panel A: Main estimates						
Change Black share	-0.022** (0.008)	-0.029 (0.024)	0.070** (0.035)	0.025*** (0.007)	0.057*** (0.018)	0.033** (0.016)
Panel B: First stage						
Predicted change Black Share		0.780*** (0.231)	0.624** (0.247)		0.758*** (0.233)	0.758*** (0.233)
F-stat		11.41	6.39		10.57	10.57
Observations	1,263	1,263	1,069	3,789	3,789	3,789
No NAACP in 1940			X			
White participants						X

Notes: The sample includes the 1,263 non-southern US counties (see [Supplementary Table A.1](#) for the definition southern states) for which electoral returns in Congressional elections are available for all Census years between 1940 and 1970, and with at least one African American resident in 1940. The dependent variable is the 1940-60 change in the presence of NAACP chapters (columns 1-3) and the change in the probability of non-violent demonstrations in support of civil rights coordinated by the CORE (Columns 4-6). Column 3 restricts attention to counties with no NAACP chapter in 1940. Column 6 defines the dependent variable as a dummy equal to one only for demonstrations that were joined by at least some white participants. The main regressor of interest is the 1940-60 (respectively decadal) change in the Black population share in Columns 1-3 (respectively Columns 4-6), which is instrumented with the shift-share instrument described in equation (2) in the text in Columns 2, 3, 5, and 6. All regressions are weighted by 1940 county population and include interactions between period dummies and: (1) state dummies; (2) the 1940 Black population share; and (3) a dummy equal to one for Democratic incumbency in 1940. F-stat is the K-P F-stat for weak instruments. Robust standard errors, clustered at the county level, in parentheses. Significance levels: *** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.1$.

Table 4: NAACP chapters and CORE demonstrations

6.6 Figure 5: White Voters; Table 5: Whites' Attitudes from the ANES

Read: Figure 5 implies that Black votes alone cannot explain the Democratic vote-share effect. Table 5 shows warmer white attitudes toward Black Americans, NAACP, CORE, and Democrats in high-inflow states.

Economic message. The Great Migration shifted some white voters and not only Black voters.

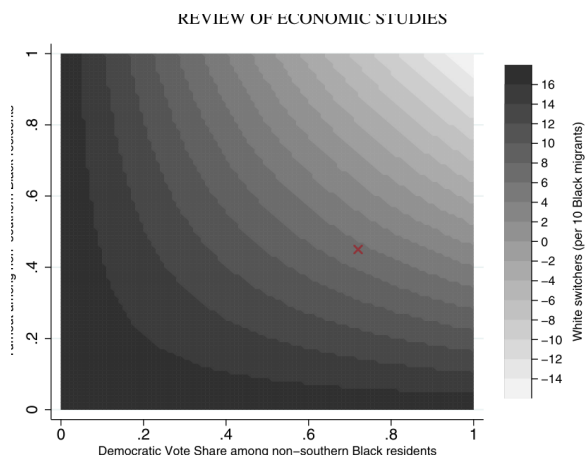


FIGURE 5

Estimates on the behaviour of White voters

Figure 5 plots the number northern white residents who would have to start voting for the Democratic Party per 10 Black out and Democratic vote share among non-southern Black residents. The solid line in black indicates combinations of Democratic vote share among non-southern Black residents that are associated with 0 white switchers. The red cross in

(a) Figure 5

Dependent variable	Feeling Thermometer Towards			MIP	I[Vote]	
	Blacks (1)	NAACP (2)	Democrats (3)	Civil Rights (4)	Democratic (5)	Democratic (6)
Panel A. 2SLS						
Change Black share	3.262*** (1.169)	2.821** (1.404)	1.895* (1.041)	0.034** (0.014)	0.039*** (0.008)	0.080*** (0.015)
Panel B. First stage						
Predicted change	2.609*** (0.415)	2.763*** (0.458)	2.611*** (0.416)	2.748*** (0.439)	2.845*** (0.436)	2.490*** (0.392)
F-stat	39.57	36.47	39.36	39.20	42.63	40.28
Observations	561	453	562	927	1,648	402
Mean Dep. variable	68.96	54.93	68.91	0.11	0.49	0.60

Notes: The sample is restricted to white ANES respondents living in the US North, and residing in their state of birth. All columns, except Columns 4 and 5, refer to 1964 only. Columns 4 and 5 include respondents interviewed in survey waves: 1960 and 1964; and 1956 to 1964, respectively. The dependent variable in Columns 1–3 is the feeling thermometer towards each group at the top of the corresponding column. Higher values of the thermometer refer to warmer feelings. Column 4, the dependent variable is a dummy equal to 1 if the respondent reports that supporting civil rights is among the most important issues facing the country at the time of the interview. See [Supplementary Appendix C](#) for exact words and additional details on the construction of the variable. In Columns 5 and 6, the dependent variable is a dummy equal to 1 if the respondent voted (respectively intended to vote) for the Democratic Party in the previous (respectively upcoming) election. The main regressor of interest is the 1940 to 1960 change in the Black population share in the state, which is instrumented with the shift-share instrument described in equation (2) in the text. All regressions are weighted with ANI survey weights, include region fixed effects, and control for individual characteristics of respondents (gender, age, education fixed effects, and marital status) as well as for 1940 state characteristics (Black population share; Democratic incumbency in Congressional elections; share in manufacturing; share of workers in the CIO; urban share). Column 4 and 5 include survey year fixed effects. F-stat refers to the K-P F-stat for weak instruments. Robust standard errors clustered at the state level, in parentheses. Significance levels: *** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.1$.

(b) Table 5

6.7 Tables 6–7 and Figures 6–7: Newspapers, Event Studies, and Heterogeneity

Read: Tables 6 and 7 show that high-inflow counties report southern lynchings more after the events occur; Figure 6 visualizes the post-event jump. Figure 7 shows stronger CORE effects where labour and political coalition forces are favourable.

Economic message. Migration transmitted information about southern racial violence and coalition-building was strongest where economic and political conditions supported cooperation.

TABLE 6
Evidence from northern newspapers: cross-sectional regressions

Dependent variable	I[Any mention]				
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Panel A: Main estimates					
Change Black share	0.253** (0.128)	0.135 (0.086)	0.348** (0.163)	0.532** (0.235)	0.677** (0.301)
Panel B: First stage					
Predicted change	1.071*** (0.289)	1.032*** (0.287)	1.098*** (0.291)	1.093*** (0.291)	1.081*** (0.289)
F-stat	13.76	12.95	14.26	14.08	13.96
Observations	311,803	141,332	170,471	79,721	59,665
State FE	X	X	X	X	X
Episode FE	X	X	X	X	X
Week FE	X	X	X	X	X
Sample	1940+	1940-1944	1945+	1950+	1955+

Notes: The sample is restricted to the 492 counties in our sample for which newspapers' data are available. The table reports county-week-episode level regressions where the dependent variable is a dummy equal to 1 if at least one mention about the lynching of a Black individual in the US South appeared in the local newspapers of the county in each week from 0 to 26. Week 0 is defined as the week in which the lynching occurred. The main regressor of interest is the 1940–4 change in the Black population share in the county, which is instrumented with the shift-share instrument described in equation (2) in the text. All regressions include state, week, and episode fixed effects and are weighted by 1940 county population. The last row of the table indicates the sample of lynchings considered. When the last year is not specified, corresponds to 1964 (included). F-stat refers to the K-P F-stat for weak instruments. Robust standard errors, clustered at the county level, in parentheses. Significance levels: *** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.1$.

what follows, we consider all newspapers, but results are unchanged when excluding from our

(a) Table 6

TABLE 7
Evidence from northern newspapers: event-study design

Dependent variable	I[Any mention]					
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Panel A. 1940–60 change in Black share						
Change Black Share * POST	0.237* (0.126)	0.113 (0.085)	0.325** (0.162)	0.476** (0.228)	0.691** (0.306)	1.050* (0.262)
F-stat	13.61	12.76	14.04	13.78	13.5	12.87
Observations	357,979	162,303	195,671	91,544	68,520	22,047
Events	1940+	1940–44	1945+	1950+	1955+	1960+
Panel B. Decadal changes in Black share						
Change Black share * POST	0.248 (0.161)	0.764** (0.317)	1.127** (0.447)	0.262 (0.189)	1.194* (0.625)	1.825* (0.534)
F-stat	20.96	22.95	22.51	8.43	8.62	8.23
Observations	162,303	195,671	91,544	266,429	68,520	22,047
Change Black share	1940–50	1940–50	1940–50	1950–60	1950–60	1950–19
Events	1940–44	1945+	1950+	1940–1949	1955+	1960+
County FE	X	X	X	X	X	X
Episode FE	X	X	X	X	X	X
State-week FE	X	X	X	X	X	X

Notes: The sample is restricted to the 492 counties in our sample for which newspapers' data are available. The table reports county-week-episode level regressions where the dependent variable is a dummy equal to 1 if at least one mention about the lynching of a Black individual in the US South appeared in the local newspapers of the county in each week from –4 to 26. Week 0 is defined as the week in which the lynching occurred. The main regressor of interest is 1940–60 (respectively decadal) change in the Black population share in the county in Panel A (respectively Panel B) interacted with an indicator for Weeks 0 and above (POST). The change in the Black population share is instrumented with the shift-share instrument described in equation (2) in the text. All regressions include county, state by week, episode fixed effects, and are weighted by 1940 county population. Columns 1 to 3 (respectively 4–6) of Panel B consider the 1940–50 (respectively 1950–60) change in the Black population share. The last row of the table indicates the sample of lynchings considered. When the last year is not specified, it corresponds to 1964 (included). F-stat refers to the K-P F-stat for weak instruments. Robust standard errors, clustered at the county level, in parentheses. Significance levels: *** $p < 0.01$, ** $p < 0.05$, * $p < 0.1$.

(b) Table 7

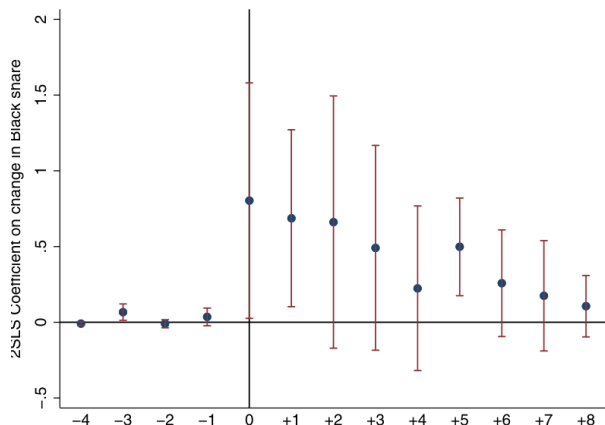


FIGURE 6
Newspapers—event study

Figure 6 plots 2SLS coefficients (with corresponding 95% intervals) on the 1940–60 change in the Black population; level regressions where the dependent variable is a dummy equal to one if any mention about the lynching of a Black youth appeared in newspapers of the (non-southern) county in each week. Week 0 refers to the week when the lynching first appeared in the text for more details. All regressions control for state and lynching episode fixed effects and are weighted by population.

(a) Figure 6

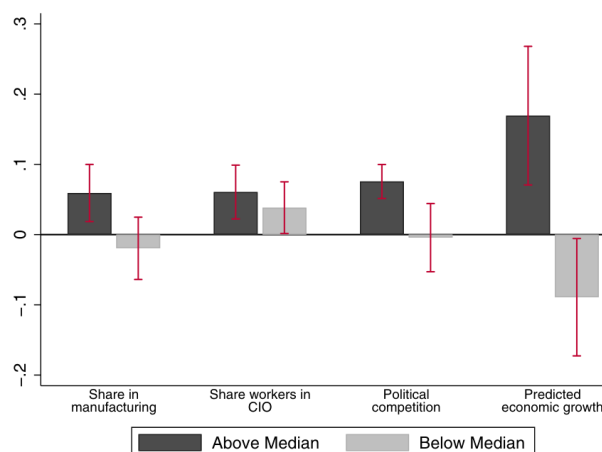


FIGURE 7
Heterogeneity by county characteristics—political and economic forces
The bars report the 2SLS coefficient (with corresponding 95% confidence intervals) on the change in the Black population; level regressions where the dependent variable is a dummy equal to one if any mention about the lynching of a Black youth appeared in newspapers of the (non-southern) county in each week. Week 0 refers to the week when the lynching first appeared in the text for more details. All regressions control for state and lynching episode fixed effects and are weighted by population.

(b) Figure 7

7 Short summary

- The paper links the Second Great Migration to the rise of northern support for civil rights.
- Black inflows increased Democratic vote shares, legislator support for civil-rights bills, NAACP/CORE mobilization, and white pro-civil-rights attitudes.
- Newspaper evidence shows an information channel through coverage of southern lynchings.
- Heterogeneity suggests cross-race coalitions were strongest where labour and Democratic institutions were favourable.

8 Conclusion

8.1 Core conclusion

The Great Migration was not only a demographic shock; it was a political input into the national civil-rights coalition.

8.2 Incremental contribution revisited

The paper contributes by showing that migration can generate majority support for minority rights rather than only backlash. It links demographic change to electoral incentives, legislator behaviour, civil-rights organizations, information diffusion, and white attitude change.

8.3 Mechanism

Migration changed the electorate, expanded Black organizations, increased salience of southern racial violence, and enabled labour-Democratic cross-race coalitions.

8.4 Limits and open questions

The paper identifies the effect of Black inflows, but not the relative importance of every force behind civil rights. Future work can examine persistence, sorting, intergenerational transmission, and other media channels.

8.5 Takeaway

Intergroup contact can produce cooperation when groups share goals, institutions reduce conflict, and information about injustice becomes salient.